



Hackathon Details

Christ University Hackathon · September 26-28, 2026

Quick Facts

Detail	Info
Format	Online, 24 hours
Start	10:00 AM, Saturday, September 26, 2026
End	10:00 AM, Sunday, September 27, 2026
Briefing	9:30 - 10:00 AM, Saturday, September 26 (this document is presented live)
Team size	2 members
Where you build	Anthrena Desk, the statistics and dashboarding app. It's the only tool allowed for cleaning, analysis, dashboards, and the live presentation
Themes	5 choices, pick one at kickoff (details below)
Submission	Two things, by 10:00 AM Sunday: your saved Anthrena Desk file (.asbx) and a published, public dashboard link
Evaluation	Live presentation of your submission to judges, Monday, September 28 10.00AM

Full Schedule

Three milestones are graded pod meetings on Google Meet with your mentors, not optional. Everything else is build time.

Time	Milestone	What happens
9:30 - 10:00 AM (Sat)	Kickoff briefing	Rules, timeline walkthrough, theme selection, live Q&A. This document is shown on screen.
10:00 AM (Sat)	Hackathon begins	Teams pick a theme and start sourcing data.
10:00 AM - 12:00 PM	Team huddle + dataset sourcing	Read your theme brief closely, split responsibilities, find your dataset.
12:00 - 1:00 PM	Milestone 1: Data Collection & Problem Statement Chosen (pod meeting, 10 marks)	Join your pod's Meet with your mentors. Confirm your theme and dataset, this locks your choice in.
1:00 - 4:00 PM	Build block 1: get your data ready	Derive any extra columns you need in Anthrena Desk, run your first round of statistical analysis.
4:00 - 5:00 PM	Milestone 2: Analysis & Progress Check (pod meeting, 20 marks)	Join your pod's Meet and walk your mentors through your analysis so far.
5:00 - 8:00 PM	Build block 2: find your first real insight	Push past the obvious stats. Start building the dashboard around whatever's actually turning out interesting.
8:00 - 9:00 PM	Milestone 3: Visualization & Narrative (pod meeting, 20 marks)	Join your pod's Meet with your dashboard taking shape, walk through the story it's telling.

Time	Milestone	What happens
9:00 PM - 9:30 AM	Build block 3: shape the story	Refine the dashboard and analysis around whatever your pod meeting surfaced. Final checks. Re-open your saved .asbx file
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Submission window	Submit your .asbx file and published dashboard link through the Google Form.
10:00 AM (Sun)	Hackathon ends	Submissions lock at 10:00 AM sharp. Late submissions are not accepted, no exceptions.
Monday, Sept 28	Presentations & judging	Time: 10.00 AM. Each team presents live using Anthrena Desk's built-in Presentation Mode.

Rules & Guidelines

Team & platform

- Each team uses its own Anthrena Desk account or workspace.
- Anthrena Desk is the only tool allowed for data cleaning, analysis, dashboard building, and the final presentation. Excel, Power BI, Tableau, Python, Google Sheets, Canva, and PowerPoint are not allowed at any stage.
- Only the cleaned dataset may be used to build the visualization.

Themes & data

- Problem statements are released at 10:00 AM. Pick exactly one theme and state it clearly in your dashboard. You may not switch themes after Milestone 1 locks it in.
- Use only legal, publicly accessible datasets (government open-data portals, research repositories, public APIs, openly licensed data), or your own data where you genuinely have the right to use it. Data from someone else requires their consent.
- Credit every source (dataset name, publisher, link) in your dashboard. Never show personally identifiable information, names, phone numbers, emails, or IDs.

What you're building

Every entry has three parts, all made inside Anthrena Desk:

1. A cleaned dataset (missing values, duplicates, data types, inconsistent labels, and outliers handled).
2. A dashboard that actually answers your theme's question.
3. A presentation of that dashboard using Anthrena Desk's built-in Presentation Mode, telling a clear story from problem to insight to recommendation.

Submission

- Submit two things by 10:00 AM sharp, Sunday, September 27: your .asbx file and your published, public dashboard link. Both are mandatory, an incomplete submission may be disqualified.
- Judges must be able to open your dashboard link without logging in or requesting access. Test it yourself in an incognito window before submitting.
- Submit at least 30 minutes early. The deadline is strict, no extra time is given for internet, power, device, or platform issues. The organizers' timestamp is final.
- Keep your dashboard public and unchanged after submission. Organizers may compare the live link against your submitted .asbx file.

Shortlisting & Monday presentation

- A judging panel scores all valid submissions and shortlists teams for Monday. Shortlisted teams are notified via e-mail.
- Monday, September 28, 10.00 AM, on Google Meet.
- Both members must attend and present using Presentation Mode. What you present must match what you submitted, no new changes. Teams absent at their slot may be disqualified.

Code of conduct

- All work must be original and done only by your registered team members within the 24 hours. No pre-built dashboards, no outside help, no copying or sharing files with other teams, no public posting of your solution before results.
- AI tools may not be used to build the analysis or dashboard outside Anthrena Desk.
- Tampering with the platform, the submission system, or another team's work leads to immediate disqualification.
- Grounds for disqualification: late submission, using tools other than Anthrena Desk, a broken or private dashboard link, a missing or corrupted .asbx file, editing the dashboard after the deadline, non-consented or illegal data, or any other violation of these rules.
- Participating means accepting these rules. Organizers may adjust rules or timing with notice to all teams. Organizer and judging decisions are final. You're responsible for your own connectivity and devices. Organizers may showcase submitted dashboards with credit to the team.

What Anthrena Desk Can Do

Anthrena Desk is the desktop app you'll build your whole solution in, start to finish. It covers two things:

Statistics: t-tests, ANOVA, chi-square and other frequency tests, correlation (Pearson, Spearman, Kendall), nonparametric tests, and regression.

Dashboards: bar, line, scatter, correlation matrices, treemaps, Sankey diagrams, KPI cards, drill-downs, and more, plus the built-in Presentation Mode you'll use live on Monday.

Pick whichever protocols and charts actually answer your theme's question. You don't need to use all of them, and nobody expects you to.

New to Anthrena Desk? [Anthrena Desk - Complete Course \(19 videos, connecting your data through dashboards and statistical analysis\)](#)

Choosing Your Theme & Sourcing Your Data

Finding the right dataset is part of the challenge, not a separate errand before the real work starts. Give it real time before Milestone 1.

Already have your own data? If you've got something that genuinely fits your theme, your own Spotify or music-listening export, activity logs from a personal project, whatever it is, you're welcome to use it instead of hunting for a public dataset. It just needs to be genuinely yours to use.

If what you find looks thin: join it with a second free dataset that shares a key (title, artist, track name), that's normal practice, not a workaround. Where no second dataset exists, derive new columns from a timestamp or text field you already have, hour of day, day of week, title length, and so on. Either move is a legitimate part of the analysis, budget time for it.

Choose Your Theme

Five themes, each with a real question at its core and room to make it your own.

Theme 1 - The Hidden Scoreboard

Cricket, Formula 1, or any sport you can get data for. A batting average or a championship position is a summary number, and summaries hide exactly the moments and decisions that actually won or lost it. This theme is sport-agnostic: pick cricket, F1, or another sport with solid public data, and find what the scoreboard doesn't show.

Your solution could explore: whether a player's average undersells how often they actually shift a match's momentum, whether you can isolate a driver's pace from their car's advantage using sector times, or whether certain partnerships or drivers reliably outperform their season average in specific conditions.

What a great solution looks like: it names one specific player, driver, or moment where the standard numbers hide the real story, backed by a clear, reproducible metric.

Theme 2 - Four Stars, Different Reasons

What makes a movie worth watching. A star rating hides more than it reveals; two people can give the same film four stars for completely different reasons. Build a solution that goes past the average score to explain audience preferences.

Your solution could explore: whether people who loved one specific movie share a pattern in what else they rate highly, whether some other factor in your dataset (genre, era, runtime) predicts rating better than expected, or what kind of movie causes the widest critic-audience split.

What a great solution looks like: it points to one specific movie where critic and audience scores diverge sharply, and offers a real explanation for the gap, not just the size of the gap.

Theme 3 - Your Playlist Is Lying to You

Understanding listening habits through music data. Everyone thinks they know their own music taste, until the play history says otherwise. Build a music intelligence application that finds real patterns in listening behavior.

Your solution could explore: whether someone has a consistent “type,” or their library just looks that way from a few obsessive weeks, whether there's a version of them that only shows up late at night musically, or what a stranger would get wrong about someone's taste from play counts alone.

What a great solution looks like: it names a specific, surprising moment in someone's listening history, not a generic top-artists breakdown.

Theme 4 - Whoever's Loudest Isn't Always Right

What drives discussions in online communities. By the time a topic looks like a trend, it usually already is one. Build a solution that analyzes public discussion data (a forum, a subreddit, a comment section) to catch momentum building, and tell real community consensus apart from a vocal minority.

Discussion data often starts narrow: just the post, the author, a score, a timestamp. Deriving new columns, hour of day, title length, reply count, is expected here, not a detour from the real analysis.

Your solution could explore: whether you can catch a topic gaining momentum before it turns into an obvious trend, whether the most-commented threads reflect what the community broadly cares about, or whether the same story lands on different conclusions in different communities.

What a great solution looks like: it surfaces one concrete example, a topic that built momentum for days before spiking, or two communities that reached opposite conclusions about the same event.

Theme 5 - Cracking the Algorithm

Why some videos trend and most don't. Some videos with real production value get nothing, and some shaky phone clip gets ten million views. Build a solution that actually tests what separates a video that trends from one that doesn't, instead of guessing.

Your solution could explore: whether a catchy or clickbait-style title actually correlates with trending, whether there's a specific upload time or day that shows up disproportionately among trending videos, or whether early engagement rate predicts trending better than channel size alone.

What a great solution looks like: it names one specific, testable factor that actually predicts trending in the data, not a vague “good content wins” conclusion.

Evaluation Rubric (100 marks total)

Component	Marks
Milestone 1: Data Collection & Problem Statement Chosen	10
Milestone 2: Analysis & Progress Check	20
Milestone 3: Visualization & Narrative	20
.asbx submission	50
Total	100

.asbx submission breakdown (50 marks)

Item	Marks
Problem understanding and relevance (1st slide)	5
Visualization: right usage of charts	15
Visualization: dashboard design	10
Creativity and effective use of Anthrena	15
Dashboard structuring & flow (slides of dashboard flow)	5

Submission Requirements

- Two files: your Anthrena Desk save file (.asbx) and your published, public dashboard link.
- Submit both through the Google Form (link: [TBD]) by 10:00 AM sharp, Sunday, September 27.
- Test your dashboard link yourself in an incognito window before submitting, judges must be able to open it without logging in.
- No repo link, demo video, or slide deck required beyond this, you'll walk judges through your work live on Monday using Presentation Mode instead.